Meridian

Seed round, November 2026

Meridian

Dock scheduling and driver messaging for mid-size freight forwarders

EUR 41.2k
MRR, October 2026

32
paying customers

EUR 3M
raising, priced equity round

Trucks waited 94 minutes at one Hamburg site in 2024, and carriers sent the bill

EUR 38,000

waiting fees paid at that one site in 2024

published customer case study, 2025

- Dispatchers run the yard with phones, WhatsApp groups and a paper notebook
- Most trucks arrive in the morning peak; the docks sit idle in the afternoon
- Carriers used to absorb waiting time. Now they invoice it

Source: published customer case study, 2025

Carriers book a dock slot through a link: no app, no login

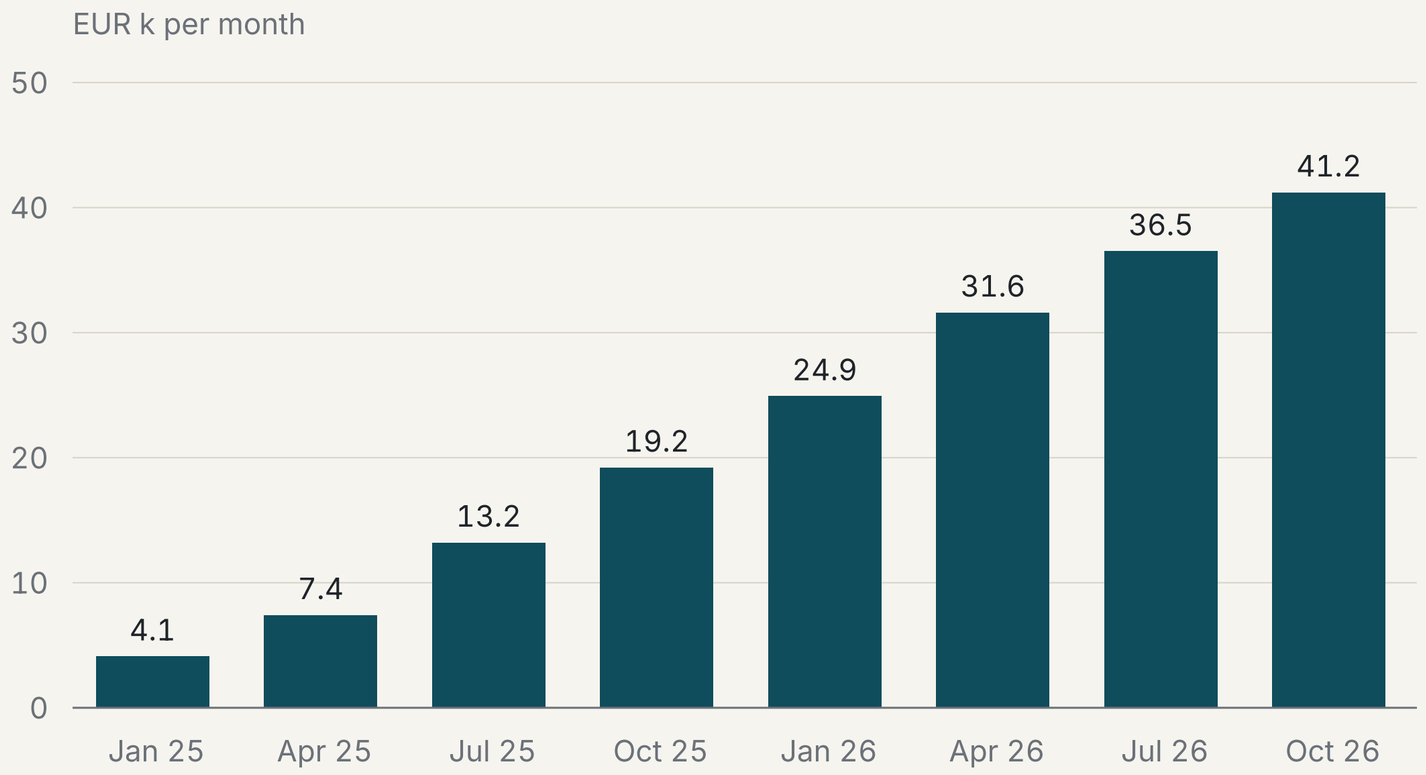
Drivers get slot changes by SMS or WhatsApp in German, English, Polish or Romanian

The gatehouse checks trucks in and out on a tablet; dispatchers see one inbox instead of six phones

At the first customer's Hamburg site, dock wait per truck fell from 94 to 65 minutes in the first three months (one site, March to May 2025)

Source: published customer case study, 2025

MRR grew 2.15x in 12 months to EUR 41.2k in October 2026



Source: data/metrics-2026-10.csv

EUR 41.2k

MRR, October 2026

data/metrics-2026-10.csv

32

paying customers, October 2026

data/metrics-2026-10.csv

3

customers lost in 22 months, January 2025 to October 2026

data/metrics-2026-10.csv

The driver side wins or loses the deal, so we built for the driver first

- A customer's head of operations: "I do not need a yard management system. I need the drivers to stop calling me."
- Everyone builds for the dispatcher. We build for a subcontractor driver in his cab with a cracked phone screen
- Comms is the wedge, scheduling is the lock-in: customers come to stop the phone calls and stay for the schedule

11 days

working days to go live at the first customer site, 2025

published customer case study, 2025

Source: published customer case study, 2025

Customers pay EUR 1,288 a month on average, priced per site

EUR 1,288

average MRR per customer, October 2026

data/metrics-2026-10.csv

82%

gross margin in our 2026 model (assumption, not yet from the accounts)

data/financial-model-v3.xlsx

- One price unit: a monthly fee per site. Carriers and drivers use it without an account
- Planned for Q4 2027: per-movement pricing for high-volume sites, where per-site pricing undercharges today

Source: data/metrics-2026-10.csv, data/financial-model-v3.xlsx

We estimate 14,000 target companies in DACH and Benelux, about EUR 216M a year

needs number

TAM: mid-size logistics operators across Europe; count not yet sourced

EUR 216M

SAM: 14,000 companies x EUR 1,288 a month x 12 (assumption)

notes/founder-memo-nov-2026.md, data/metrics-2026-10.csv

EUR 2.5M

SOM: our ARR target for end 2028 (projection)

data/financial-model-v3.xlsx

- Company count: our desk research on Destatis and Eurostat data (2025), freight and warehousing companies with two or more sites

Source: notes/founder-memo-nov-2026.md, data/metrics-2026-10.csv, data/financial-model-v3.xlsx

Founder-led sales adds 1.5 customers a month; the round builds a sales team

1

Beachhead: multi-site freight forwarders, 3PLs and cross-dock operators in DACH and Benelux

2

Today: both founders sell, through the CEO's network, trade shows and customer referrals

3

Next: account executives hired from the round close deals without a founder in the room

1.5

new customers a month, Jan 2025 to Oct 2026

data/metrics-2026-10.csv

18

open deals, all owned by a founder today

data/pipeline.csv

Source: data/metrics-2026-10.csv, data/pipeline.csv

Built for the forwarder’s dispatcher and driver, not the shipper’s buyer

	Meridian	Enterprise yard systems	Slot-booking marketplaces	Phone, WhatsApp, Excel
Built for	Mid-size forwarders	Large shippers	Shippers, retail DCs	Any small site
Time to go live	2 weeks	6 months	not known	none
Who pays	Site, per month	Site, plus setup	Carrier, per booking	Nobody
TMS integrations	Not yet	Yes	not known	None

- Where they are ahead: enterprise systems have TMS integrations and we do not yet. A light mid-market product from one of them would hurt

Source: notes/competitors.md

Lena ran the customer’s job for nine years; Jonas built the first version alone

LO

Lena Ostrowski

CEO, sells

9 years in logistics operations, last as Head of Operations DACH at an 11-site forwarder

JH

Jonas Hebbel

CTO, writes the code

11 years in software; led a fleet routing team of about 20 engineers; built carrier messaging at a telco provider

Team of 7 in Berlin. Lena was a customer of Jonas's previous company; the customer success lead was a dispatcher at a customer site

Raising EUR 3M for about 19 months to make the sale repeat without the founders

Priced equity round. About 19 months of runway from a January 2027 close (projection on the model's costs).

Use of funds



- Go-to-market: 4 account executives, 1 SDR, 1 marketing lead 60%
- Product: 3 engineers, 1 designer 30%
- Operations and buffer 10%

What it buys

Q1 2027: two more account executives start; carrier scorecards ship

Q2 2027: connectors to the three TMS products our customers use

2027: account executives close deals without a founder in the room

Mid 2028, when the round is spent: ARR of needs number (model being revised)

Source: README.md, notes/founder-memo-nov-2026.md, data/financial-model-v3.xlsx

Meridian

Meridian: dock scheduling and driver messaging for mid-size freight forwarders

EUR 41.2k MRR in October 2026, up 2.15x in 12 months

32 paying customers; 3 lost in 22 months

Raising EUR 3M to make the sale repeat without the founders

Lena Ostrowski, CEO. lena@meridian-ops.example

Sources

21 figures from 7 source files. Each figure has an entry in the fact ledger (facts.yaml) that names its file and location.

Source file	Figures	Kinds	Slides
data/metrics-2026-10.csv	8	7 facts, 1 assumption	1, 4, 6 to 8, 12
README.md	1	1 fact	1, 11, 12
published customer case study, 2025	3	3 facts	2, 3, 5
data/financial-model-v3.xlsx	3	1 assumption, 2 projections	6, 7, 11
notes/founder-memo-nov-2026.md	5	5 assumptions	7, 11
data/pipeline.csv	1	1 fact	8
notes/competitors.md	1	1 assumption	9